

Proposal for Emoji: Stomach

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Identification

Suggested name: Stomach

Suggested keywords: digestion; gut; belly; abdomen; hunger; appetite; fullness; nausea; indigestion; reflux

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The design uses the stomach's familiar asymmetric J shape, with a long inlet, open inner curve, broad lower body, and short outlet. These features keep it recognizable at emoji size and separate it from food, beans, and other organs. Vendors may vary the angle, color, outline, and shading while preserving the J shape, inlet, inner curve, and outlet.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Stomach has established anatomical, emotional, and figurative meanings. It can refer to the digestive organ, hunger or fullness, a nervous stomach, butterflies in the stomach, tolerance expressed through a strong stomach, and the ability to accept something unpleasant. These meanings support ordinary communication about food, sensation, emotion, and tolerance without depending on a newly invented pun.

Cambridge Dictionary documents both the expression butterflies in your stomach and the verb sense of stomach, meaning to accept or deal with something unpleasant:

<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/butterflies-in-stomach>

<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/stomach>

B. Use in sequences

Stomach adds a specific organ meaning to several short combinations:

- Stomach + fork and knife: hunger, a meal's effect, fullness, or digestion.
- Stomach + nauseated face: an upset stomach, nausea, or a stomach bug.
- Stomach + butterfly: nervous anticipation or butterflies in the stomach.
- Stomach + pill or hospital: antacid use, digestive treatment, or stomach-specific care.

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. Nauseated Face expresses a symptom, and food emoji represent what is eaten. Neither identifies the stomach itself. No current emoji or short sequence directly represents the stomach as an organ and broad semantic building block. Stomach therefore adds a distinct concept for digestion, hunger, fullness, physical sensation, figurative expression, education, and health.

D. Distinctiveness

The selected image uses an asymmetric J shape, long inlet, deep inner concavity, broad lower body, and separate outlet. Its identity rests on silhouette rather than color or fine internal texture. The open concavity and two connected passages distinguish it from Anatomical Heart, Beans, Meat on Bone, Kidney, Liver, and a generic organ shape.

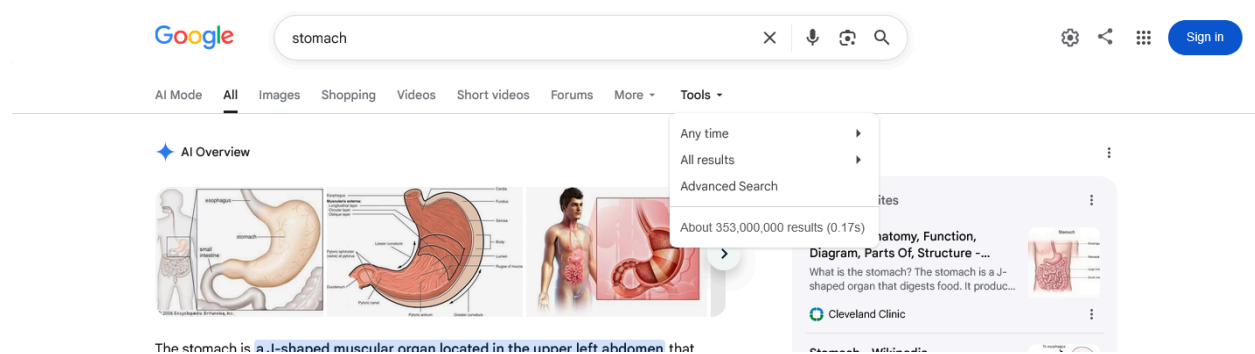
At 18x18, the color and black-and-white versions retain the J shape, open inner curve, inlet, and outlet. These features remain visible without relying on color and distinguish Stomach from Anatomical Heart, Beans, Meat on Bone, Kidney, Liver, and a generic organ shape.

E. Expected usage level

Stomach is an ordinary term used in communication about digestion, eating, hunger, appetite, fullness, nausea, stomach aches, indigestion, reflux, medication, education, and figurative emotion. The five required frequency sources show broad and durable use across web search, video, image search, and published books. Google Trends and Google Books compare `stomach` with Unicode's reference term `elephant`.

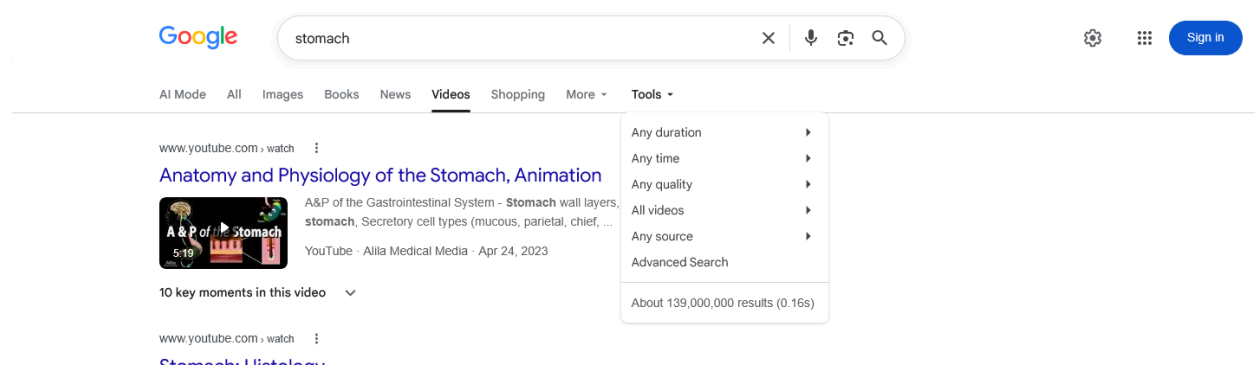
Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. Google Search displays about 353,000,000 results for `stomach`. Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?q=stomach&hl=en&filter=0>



Google Video Search

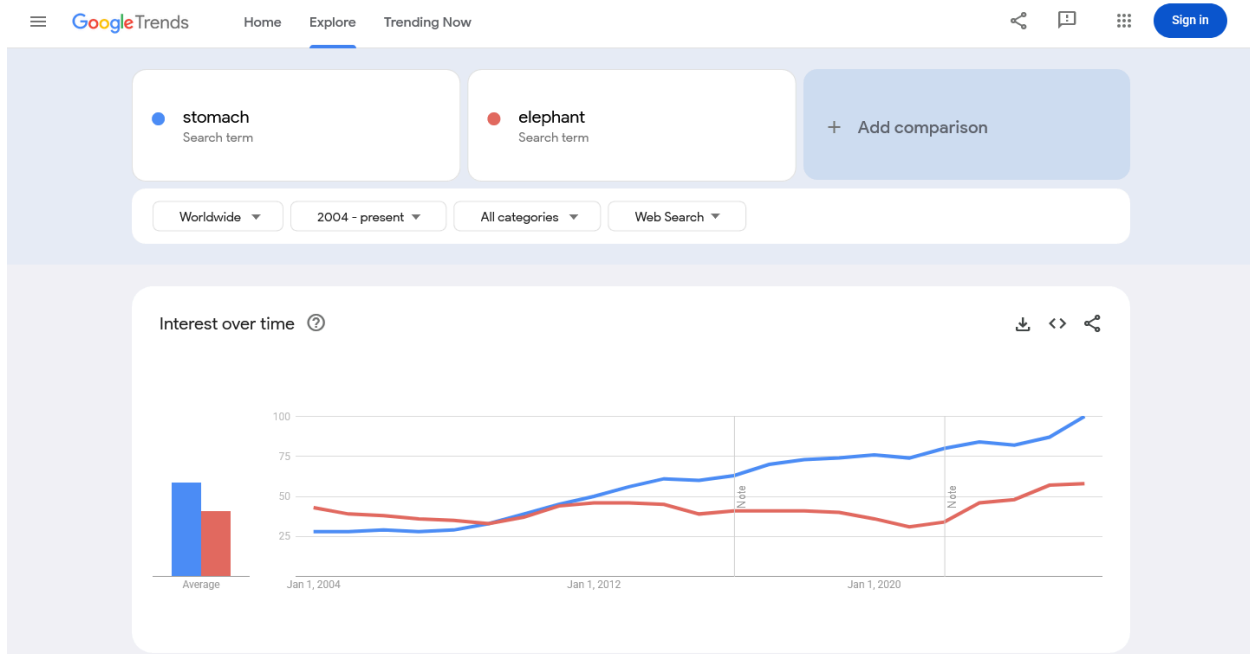
Captured 2026-07-26. Google Video Search displays about 139,000,000 results for `stomach`. Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=stomach&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>



Google Trends - Web Search

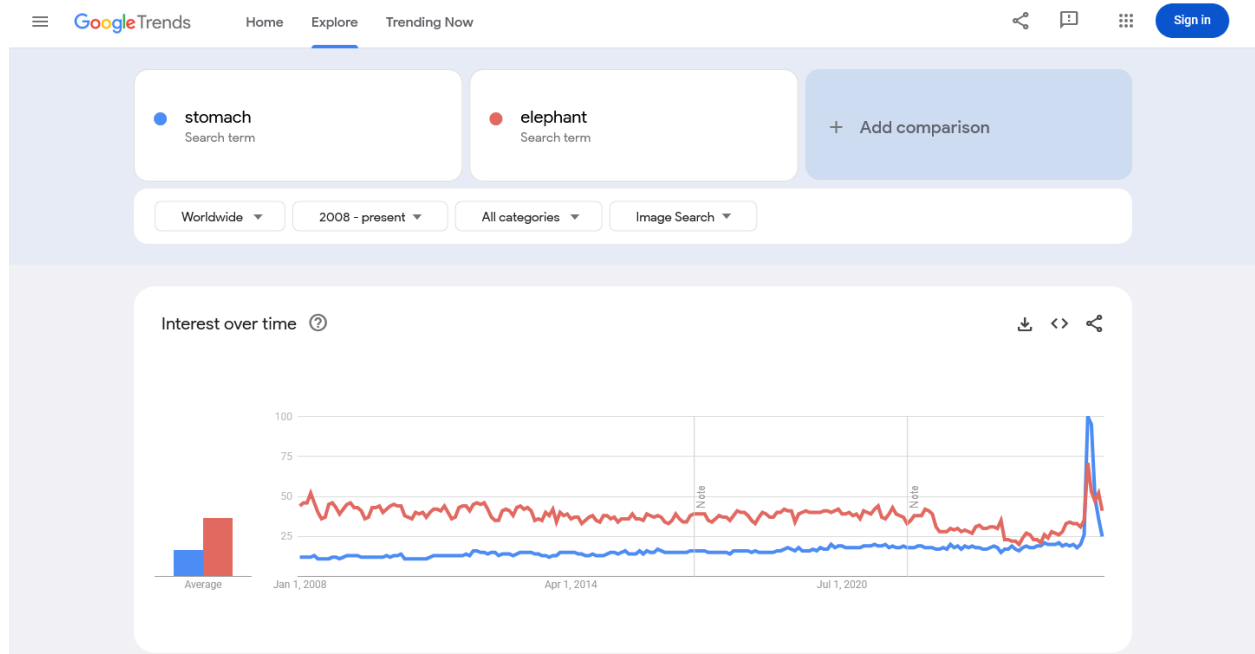
Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Stomach has the higher displayed average across the full range and a strong sustained lead in recent years.

Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=stomach,elephant>



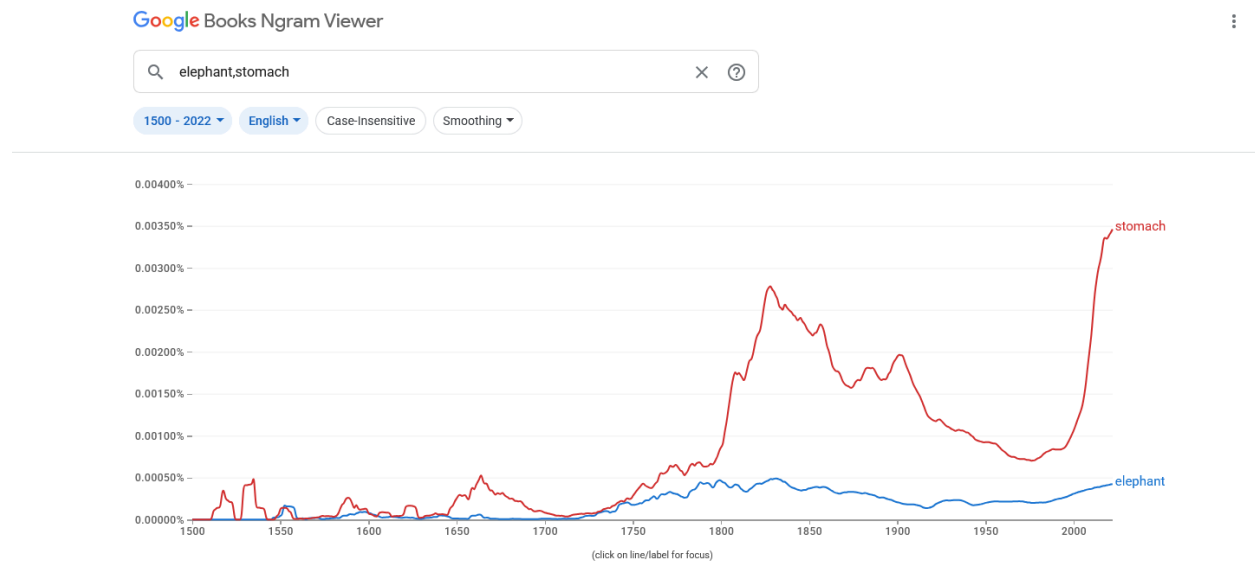
Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Stomach shows sustained worldwide image-search interest across the full available range and a strong recent peak above elephant. Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&gprop=images&q=stomach,elephant>



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-26 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, case-insensitive matching, and smoothing 3. Stomach substantially exceeds elephant in the latest displayed years and shows durable published-book use across the longest available range. Reproducible query: https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cstomach&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Stomach is independently useful and is not proposed to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Nauseated Face can express nausea, and food emoji can identify meals or ingredients, but neither identifies the stomach itself. Hospital and pill can imply care or treatment without naming the affected organ. These substitutes cannot clearly express stomach-specific anatomy, digestion, hunger, fullness, discomfort, or figurative stomach meanings.

B. Overly specific

Stomach is a broad, familiar organ concept, not a disease, procedure, specialty, campaign, subtype, organization, or brand. It supports ordinary communication across food, digestion, sensation, emotion, education, nutrition, and health.

C. Open-ended

Encoding Stomach would not imply encoding liver, kidney, intestine, or every anatomical structure. Stomach stands on its own demonstrated usage, established figurative meanings, independent semantic gap, and compact J-shaped visual paradigm. Other concepts can be judged independently under the same criteria.

D. Transient

Stomach is a durable term and concept. The long-range Google Books record documents published use across centuries, while established expressions such as butterflies in the stomach and the verb sense of stomach are documented in current dictionaries. The proposal is not tied to a temporary event, product, or campaign.

E. Faulty comparison

The proposal does not depend on Anatomical Heart, Lungs, Brain, or another organ already being encoded. Its case rests on Stomach's own ordinary usage, established meanings, recognizable paradigm, and remaining gap in the emoji vocabulary.

Other Information

The singular common name Stomach is concise and searchable. Essential design cues are an asymmetric J-shaped hollow-organ body, a long visible inlet, a deep open inner concavity, and a distinct rounded outlet. Fine anatomical detail is optional and should yield to legibility at 18x18. Vendors should avoid a form that reads primarily as food, a bean, or a generic pink shape.